



Christian Klein

Chief Executive Officer

1972
Founded

€9.7B
Q4 2025 revenue

€77B
Total cloud backlog

2/3
Cloud orders with AI

€8.24B
Free cash flow

01 Who You're Meeting

Christian Klein — Chief Executive Officer, SAP.

In role: Co-CEO from 11 October 2019 with Jennifer Morgan; sole CEO since 20 April 2020

Today: Holds overall responsibility for SAP's strategic direction, management and performance — currently the Autonomous Enterprise strategy, the shift of the roadmap toward agents, and the move to value-based pricing.

A career-long SAP insider who joined as a student in 1999 and rose through finance and operations rather than sales or product. He was Chief Financial Officer of SAP SuccessFactors, then SAP's Chief Controlling Officer, then Chief Operating Officer of SAP from 2016 to 2021. He joined the Executive Board in 2018 as head of the Intelligent Enterprise Group, combining global responsibility for the development and delivery of SAP's core applications with a cross-board mandate for global business operations — an unusually broad brief that prepared him for the CEO role.

Career: Chief Executive Officer, SAP SE; Co-Chief Executive Officer (with Jennifer Morgan), SAP SE; Executive Board member, head of the Intelligent Enterprise Group, SAP SE; Chief Operating Officer, SAP SE

Education: International Business Administration, University of Cooperative Education, Mannheim

The company: The dominant ERP vendor, with a record €77B total cloud backlog and Business AI included in two-thirds of Q4 2025 cloud order entry. Joule customer numbers grew ninefold across 2025, and SAP is now shifting its product roadmap from features toward autonomous agents.

What they sell: S/4HANA and the Cloud ERP Suite delivered through RISE with SAP and GROW with SAP, plus Business Data Cloud, the Business Technology Platform, and Business AI — the Joule assistant, Joule Work, the Business AI Platform, and the Autonomous Suite agents.

02 Where The Company Sits

SAP's structural argument is the one that matters most for asset-heavy businesses: general-purpose models cannot reach the business data that sits inside an ERP, and Joule can. Klein's own example is a customer win where SAP replaced a competitor by combining LLMs with its business data foundation to reinvent last-mile delivery logistics — a capability he argues competitors without deep ERP data cannot replicate. Two forward signals worth tracking.

03 Talking Points

- Finance and operations background, not sales — he engages on business case and delivery economics before capability.
- He is explicitly open to outcome-based pricing. For a portfolio ERP conversation that is an open door, not a fight.
- The roadmap has been redirected toward agents. If a PortCo expects conventional feature delivery, set that expectation now.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- The share price fell sharply on Q4 earnings day — in some markets the largest single-day drop since 2020 — on near-term cloud backlog dynamics
- Current cloud backlog growth decelerated through mid-2025, from 29% to 22%, which Klein attributed to tariff-driven uncertainty
- Redirecting the development backlog from features to agents risks disappointing customers on conventional roadmap commitments

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. SAP is the most likely core ERP at asset-heavy PortCos, which makes it a Corporate Functions Efficiency play in the reference model, and potentially an Asset Optimization one wherever operational data already sits inside the SAP estate.

BlackRock: No publicly disclosed operating relationship.

Others at SAP: Dominik Asam (Chief Financial Officer)

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